



Budget Estimate Prototype → Production MVP

A rough-order-of-magnitude (ROM) budget to deliver the production MVP with a five-person team, plus the steady-state run-rate at initial scale.

Document	2 of 3 — Budget Estimate (ROM)
Date	June 10, 2026
Basis	Build telemetry through commit 7af2303
Team	5 people: Tech Lead + 3 developers + 1 QA
Duration	~8 months to deployable MVP
ROM build cost	~\$1.2M ($\pm 25\%$)
Steady-state run-rate	~\$1.85M / yr at initial scale

CONFIDENTIAL — Prepared for internal planning & deployment approval. Estimates are rough-order-of-magnitude planning figures, not commitments.

1. Summary

This is a rough-order-of-magnitude estimate ($\pm 25\%$) to take the prototype to a deployable production MVP, followed by the annual cost to operate it at the initial target scale of 2,500 districts / 25,000 teachers. Personnel dominates the build; infrastructure and compliance are the next largest lines. All figures are 2026 USD.

Headline	Amount	Notes
Build-to-MVP (ROM, ~8 months)	\$1,240,000	One-time program cost to first production deploy
Steady-state run-rate (per year)	\$1,850,000 / yr	Ongoing team + production operations at initial scale
Production infrastructure (initial scale)	\$360,000 / yr	\$30,000/mo; scales with usage
Blended loaded labor rate	~\$108 / hr	\$225,000/yr per head, 5-person team
Unit economics — all-in / teacher	~\$74 / yr	Run-rate $\div$ 25,000 teachers

ROM basis: intended for budget approval and sizing, not a fixed bid. Largest sensitivities: roster-connector complexity, Planning/Orchestration scope, and compliance timing.

2. Assumptions

- Five-person core team for ~8 months; US-based; fully-loaded cost = base $\times$ 1.4 (benefits, taxes, overhead, tooling).
- MVP scope = the four capability areas; reuse of the validated event backbone and teacher loop.
- AWS, single US region, multi-AZ; production sized for initial scale, ramping in the final ~3 months of the build.
- Compliance scope for launch: FERPA/COPPA controls, SOC 2 readiness, penetration test, WCAG 2.1 AA audit.
- Excludes sales, marketing, G&A, customer support org, and curriculum/media content production.

3. Personnel

Role	FTE	Base	Loaded / yr	8-mo cost
Tech Lead / Principal Engineer (you)	1	\$205,000	\$287,000	\$191,000
Senior Developer	3	\$160,000	\$224,000	\$448,000
QA Analyst	1	\$115,000	\$161,000	\$107,000
Team total	5	blended \$108/hr	\$1,120,000 / yr	\$746,000

Blended loaded rate = total annual loaded cost (\$1,120,000) $\div$ 5 $\div$ 2,080 hrs $\approx$ \$108/hr.

4. Infrastructure & tooling (build phase)

Item	Cost	Notes
Dev + staging + CI cloud (8 mo)	\$40,000	~\$5,000/mo
Production environment ramp (final ~3 mo)	\$45,000	Pre-launch prod stand-up

Item	Cost	Notes
Developer & ops tooling (GitHub, IDEs, etc.)	\$18,000	Per-seat SaaS
Observability & error tracking (build)	\$14,000	APM, logging, Sentry
Subtotal	\$117,000	

5. Third-party services & licenses (build phase)

Service / license	Cost	Purpose
Clever / ClassLink certification & partnership	\$20,000	Roster SSO + sync
Email / SMS (SES / SNS)	\$6,000	Notifications
MDM (Jamf) for managed iPad Web Clip	\$8,000	Device distribution
Productivity & design SaaS (Figma, etc.)	\$8,000	Team tooling
Security tooling (SBOM, dep/secret scanning)	\$12,000	Supply-chain
Subtotal	\$54,000	

6. Compliance & professional services (pre-launch)

Item	Cost
Privacy & legal counsel (FERPA/COPPA, DPAs, ToS)	\$30,000
SOC 2 readiness assessment	\$25,000
Penetration test (pre-launch)	\$25,000
WCAG 2.1 AA / Section 508 audit	\$15,000
Subtotal	\$95,000

7. One-time & capital

Item	Cost
Brand & accessibility design tokens	\$15,000
Test devices (iPads + MDM enrollment)	\$10,000
Subtotal	\$25,000

8. Build-to-MVP total (ROM)

Personnel (5 people, 8 months)	\$746,000
Infrastructure & tooling (build)	\$117,000
Third-party services & licenses	\$54,000
Compliance & professional services	\$95,000
One-time & capital	\$25,000
Subtotal	\$1,037,000
Contingency (20%, ROM)	\$207,000
Build-to-MVP total (ROM)	~\$1,244,000

Duration: ~8 months to first production deploy (range 7–9 months depending on roster-connector and compliance timing).

9. Steady-state run-rate (post-MVP, per year)

Personnel (5 people, ongoing)	\$1,120,000
Production infrastructure (initial scale)	\$360,000
Third-party services & licenses	\$65,000
Compliance (renewals, pen test, tooling)	\$60,000
Subtotal	\$1,605,000

Contingency (15%)	\$241,000
Annual run-rate	~\$1,846,000 / yr

Per-teacher economics at initial scale: ~\$74/yr all-in; ~\$14/yr infrastructure-only — a useful floor for SaaS pricing. Costs scale with teachers/students, not districts.